



Hey, have you ever spotted a bird with a zebra-like pattern on its wings and a brilliant bright red cap? That's our friend, the Gila woodpecker! These unique fellows are medium-sized woodpeckers with a round head, straight pointed bill, and a stiff, spiky tail which they use for support when they're pecking away. They have striking black and white bars on their wings and tail, and don't forget to look for that dash of red on the heads of the males!



Now that we've met our winged buddy, let's fly off to its home. These birds are residents of the hot and dry desert areas of the southwestern United States and Mexico. Their favorite hangout spots are the giant cactus plants, known as saguaros, where they drill holes to nest. Fun fact, these holes later serve as homes for other desert animals too, talk about being good neighbors!

Speaking of being good neighbors, what do you think these birds like to snack on? Their diet mainly consists of insects, but they also enjoy a mix of fruits and berries. Sometimes, they can even be seen sipping nectar from cactus flowers, just like hummingbirds! And during the breeding season, both mom and dad share the responsibility of feeding the little ones.



In the world of birds, these woodpeckers have some cool features that set them apart. Unlike many other woodpeckers, Gilas have a very special relationship with humans as they often nest in telephone poles and are even known to visit bird feeders. Also, their tongue is long and sticky, perfect for snatching up those tasty bugs! So next time you spot a bird with a funky pattern and a red cap, you'll know that's our friend, the Gila woodpecker, one of the desert's most interesting residents.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What color cap does the Gila woodpecker have?
A. Purple B. Green C. Blue D. Red
- 2) How are Gila woodpeckers like good neighbors?
A. They sing beautiful songs B. They protect other animals
C. They leave their holes for other D. They share their food
desert animals to use
- 3) What human-made structures do Gila woodpeckers nest in?
A. Telephone poles B. Barns and sheds
C. Mailboxes D. Chimneys and roofs
- 4) What giant plants do Gila woodpeckers drill holes in to nest?
A. Saguaros B. Oak trees C. Palm trees D. Bamboo plants
- 5) What distinguishes male Gila woodpeckers from females?
A. Bright, bold feathers B. A dash of red on their heads
C. A long, colourful tail D. Their larger size
- 6) Where does the Gila woodpecker live?
A. On the coastlines of Australia B. In the cold tundras of Siberia
C. Desert areas of the Mexico D. In the rainforests of South
America
- 7) What kind of tongue does the Gila woodpecker have?
A. Long and sticky B. Short and rough
C. Long and smooth D. Short and spiky
- 8) Who shares the responsibility of feeding the little ones during the breeding season?
A. The eldest baby woodpecker B. Only dad
C. Both mom and dad D. Only mom
- 9) What do Gila woodpeckers mainly eat?
A. Meat B. Insects C. Grains D. Seeds
- 10) What do Gila woodpeckers use their tongues for?
A. To drill holes in cactus B. To snatch up bugs
C. To carry their young D. To pick up twigs

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "Not only do I eat insects, sometimes I enjoy sipping sweet nectar from cactus flowers. It's my special dessert."
- 12) "You see the holes in the saguaro cacti? Yes, we made those. We're quite the carpenters, aren't we?"
- 13) "You see that flash of red on my head? If you do, then you're looking at a male, that's me!"
- 14) "I only eat nectar from cactus flowers during the breeding season."
- 15) "I'm an insect lover, that's my favorite meal!"



- 16) "Only females feed the little ones, dad is responsible for making nests."
- 17) "I only eat fruits and berries, insects are not my cup of tea."
- 18) "I have been known to use telephone poles for nesting."
- 19) "My tongue isn't just long, it's sticky too! It's the perfect tool for catching wiggly insects."
- 20) "Sometimes some other animals use the holes I made as a home."
- 21) "I prefer damp and cool climates, the desert is too hot for me."
- 22) "My meal is quite varied, I enjoy nibbling on a mix of fruits and berries when I'm not catching insects."
- 23) "I don't really like cactus, they're too prickly for me."
- 24) "Unlike some birds, my tails isn't fluffy, it's stiff."
- 25) "I live in a cold and wet environment."
- 26) "My tongue is short and slippery."
- 27) "I have a beak that's sharp and straight, perfect for drilling into cactus plants!"

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 28) Other animals may use the holes drilled by Gila woodpeckers in cactuses as homes.
- 29) It's interesting how both mom and dad Gila woodpeckers share the responsibility of feeding their young ones.
- 30) Gila woodpeckers create holes in saguaro cactuses to make nests.
- 31) The ability of Gila woodpeckers to drill holes in saguaro cacti is remarkable.
- 32) Male Gila woodpeckers have a dash of red on their heads.
- 33) The Gila woodpecker's long, sticky tongue is a very impressive adaptation.
- 34) Both male and female Gila woodpeckers feed their young.
- 35) Gila woodpeckers inhabit the desert regions of the southwestern United States and Mexico.
- 36) The red cap on a gila woodpecker is definitely the most beautiful feature of any bird.
- 37) The zebra-like pattern on Gila woodpeckers' wings is incredibly beautiful.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 38) Gila woodpeckers can be seen sipping nectar from cactus flowers.
- 39) The female Gila woodpecker is responsible for feeding the little ones.
- 40) Gila woodpeckers have a long and sticky tongue.
- 41) Gila woodpeckers live in cold and icy regions.
- 42) Gila woodpeckers drill holes in cactus plants to live in.
- 43) Gila woodpeckers only eat insects.
- 44) Gila woodpeckers build their nests in burrows underground.
- 45) Gila woodpeckers do not have tongues.
- 46) Gila woodpeckers often nest in telephone poles.
- 47) The male Gila woodpecker has a bright red cap on its head.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.

- 48) They're not just good at building homes, they're also excellent at finding food.
 - A. They have
 - B. They are
 - C. They were
 - D. They will



Gila Woodpecker

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | 67. _____ |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | 68. _____ |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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1.	D	26.	Not	51.	A
2.	C	27.	Would	52.	C
3.	A	28.	fact	53.	declarative
4.	A	29.	opinion	54.	exclamatory
5.	B	30.	fact	55.	exclamatory
6.	C	31.	opinion	56.	exclamatory
7.	A	32.	fact	57.	exclamatory
8.	C	33.	opinion	58.	declarative
9.	B	34.	fact	59.	interrogative
10.	B	35.	fact	60.	exclamatory
11.	Would	36.	opinion	61.	declarative
12.	Would	37.	opinion	62.	interrogative
13.	Would	38.	true	63.	exclamatory
14.	Not	39.	false	64.	interrogative
15.	Would	40.	true	65.	exclamatory
16.	Not	41.	false	66.	exclamatory
17.	Not	42.	true	67.	exclamatory
18.	Would	43.	false	68.	exclamatory
19.	Would	44.	false		
20.	Would	45.	false		
21.	Not	46.	true		
22.	Would	47.	true		
23.	Not	48.	B		
24.	Would	49.	A		
25.	Not	50.	D		